

SALES METHODOLOGY GUIDE

MEDDIC

Metrics · Economic Buyer · Decision Criteria ·
Decision Process · Identify Pain · Champion

A comprehensive field guide for enterprise sales excellence

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Introduction to MEDDIC

MEDDIC is a battle-tested enterprise sales qualification framework developed at PTC in the 1990s, where it helped drive the company from \$300M to over \$1B in revenue. Today it is used by leading SaaS and enterprise sales organisations worldwide to qualify deals faster, forecast more accurately, and win at higher rates.

The acronym stands for **Metrics, Economic Buyer, Decision Criteria, Decision Process, Identify Pain, and Champion**. Together, these six elements give sales teams a structured lens to evaluate every opportunity and identify the exact actions needed to move a deal forward.

Why MEDDIC?

Teams that consistently apply MEDDIC report 20–30% higher win rates, significantly improved forecast accuracy, and shorter sales cycles. It shifts conversations from product features to measurable business outcomes — the language executives care about.

The Six Pillars at a Glance

Letter	Element	Core Question
M	Metrics	What is the quantifiable value of solving this problem?
E	Economic Buyer	Who has the budget authority and final say?
D	Decision Criteria	What standards will they use to evaluate solutions?
D	Decision Process	How and when will a decision be made?
I	Identify Pain	What is the critical business problem driving urgency?
C	Champion	Who inside the account will sell for us when we're not there?

How to Use This Guide

Each section that follows dives deep into one MEDDIC element. You will find:

- A clear definition and why the element matters
- Key discovery questions to ask prospects

- Red flags that signal gaps in your qualification
- Best-practice examples from real enterprise deals
- A self-assessment checklist to score your own opportunities

Use this guide during deal reviews, as a coaching resource for your team, or as a reference when preparing for key customer conversations.

M Metrics

Quantify the value — in the customer's numbers

Metrics are the quantifiable measures of success that justify the investment in your solution. Without agreed-upon metrics, you are selling features — not business outcomes. Economic buyers speak the language of ROI, payback periods, and efficiency gains. Your job is to help the prospect define and own those numbers.

Types of Metrics to Uncover

Revenue Impact	Increase in ARR, upsell/cross-sell uplift, new market capture.
Cost Reduction	Headcount savings, infrastructure cost cuts, rework elimination.
Productivity Gain	Hours saved per week, cycle time reduction, throughput increase.
Risk Reduction	Compliance fines avoided, churn reduction, downtime prevented.
Time-to-Value	Days to onboard, speed to first outcome, deployment timeline.

Discovery Questions

- What does success look like in measurable terms 12 months from now?
- How much is the current problem costing you annually (in time, money, or risk)?
- If we could improve [KPI] by X%, what would that mean for your business?
- How are you currently measuring the impact of this challenge?
- What ROI threshold does your finance team require to approve this investment?
- What is the cost of doing nothing for another year?

Red Flags

- Prospect cannot articulate a specific metric — deal is likely curiosity, not urgency.
- Metrics are owned only by you (the rep) and not internalised by the prospect.
- ROI model has not been reviewed or validated by finance.
- Success metrics are vague: 'improve efficiency', 'save time'.

Pro Tip

Always build the business case collaboratively with your champion. A co-created ROI model is far more compelling to an economic buyer than one you deliver unilaterally. Ask: 'Can we work through the numbers together so you can present this internally?'

E Economic Buyer

Find the person who controls the budget

The Economic Buyer (EB) is the individual with the authority to release funds and approve the final purchase. They may not be your day-to-day contact — in fact, many deals stall because reps never gain access to the true EB. Engaging the EB early and at the right level is one of the highest-leverage actions in any enterprise deal.

Characteristics of an Economic Buyer

- Controls or directly influences the budget line
- Has the authority to say YES without further approval (within a threshold)
- Is ultimately accountable for the business outcome your solution affects
- Often a VP, SVP, C-suite, or P&L owner — but not always the most senior person
- Focused on business results, not technical features

Discovery Questions

- Who ultimately owns the budget for this initiative?
- Has the budget for this project already been allocated, or does it need to be approved?
- Who else needs to be part of this decision at the executive level?
- What does success look like to the person signing off on this?
- Can we schedule time with [EB name] to validate the business case directly?
- What are [EB's] top three priorities for this fiscal year?

Strategies to Gain EB Access

Executive Sponsor	Engage your own exec to reach out peer-to-peer.
Champion Request	Coach your champion to facilitate an intro: 'Would it make sense to loop in [EB]?'
Business Review	Propose an executive business review framed around their strategic goals.
Event / EBC	Invite the EB to an executive briefing centre or industry event.
Inbound Content	Share a relevant thought-leadership piece attributed to their priorities.

Red Flags

- You have never spoken with or met the EB — any stage 3+ deal is at risk.
- Your champion says 'I can handle the EB — you don't need to meet them.'
- Budget is described as 'to be determined' this late in the cycle.
- Multiple people claim to be the decision-maker.

D

Decision Criteria

Know the rules of the game before they're set

Decision Criteria (DC) are the formal and informal standards a prospect uses to evaluate and select a vendor. These include technical requirements, commercial terms, cultural fit, vendor stability, and support capabilities. The rep who helps define the criteria early — and shapes them to their strengths — wins more often.

Categories of Decision Criteria

Technical	Integration capabilities, security posture, scalability, compliance certifications.
Commercial	Pricing model, contract flexibility, total cost of ownership, payment terms.
Vendor	Company stability, customer references, industry expertise, roadmap alignment.
Implementation	Time to deploy, professional services, training, change management support.
Cultural	Relationship quality, executive alignment, responsiveness, shared values.

Discovery Questions

- What criteria are most important to you in evaluating solutions for this?
- Is there a formal RFP or scoring matrix? Can I see it?
- How are you weighting technical fit versus commercial terms?
- What would disqualify a vendor immediately?
- Who contributed to building the evaluation criteria?
- Are there any criteria that we haven't discussed yet that matter to the buying team?

Influencing Decision Criteria

The best time to shape criteria is before they are formalised. Use early discovery to understand the prospect's pain, then help them articulate evaluation standards that reflect your differentiated strengths.

- Ask: 'Have you thought about [criterion where you excel]? How important is that?'
- Share customer case studies that highlight evaluation dimensions you win on.

- Involve your SE/solutions team early to define technical criteria collaboratively.
- If an RFP exists, arrange a walkthrough call to clarify intent behind requirements.

Warning

If you receive an RFP with criteria that perfectly match a competitor, you are likely being used to validate a decision already made. Escalate immediately and re-engage the EB to reset the evaluation.

D

Decision Process

Map every step from eval to signature

The Decision Process (DP) describes the sequence of steps, stakeholders, and timelines the prospect will follow to make their purchase decision. Understanding the DP allows you to align your sales motion to the buyer's internal process — reducing surprises, preventing last-minute objections, and forecasting accurately.

Key Components of the Decision Process

- **Steps:** What are the formal stages? (Pilot → Security Review → Legal → Approval Board)
- **Stakeholders:** Who is involved at each step, and what is their role?
- **Timeline:** What is the target go-live or decision date, and why?
- **Legal & Procurement:** How long does contracting typically take?
- **Budget Cycle:** Does this align with their fiscal year or a budget event?
- **Approval Thresholds:** What level of spend requires board or exec approval?

Discovery Questions

- Walk me through how you typically make a decision of this size.
- Who else needs to be involved before this moves forward?
- What are the internal approval steps between here and contract signature?
- Has your procurement/legal team been involved yet? What do they typically review?
- Is there a board approval required for this spend level?
- What is your target date to have something in place — and what's driving that date?

Decision Process Mapping Template

Stage	Description / Owner / Est. Duration
Business Approval	VP sign-off on business case — Champion owns. 1 week.
Security Review	InfoSec team reviews architecture — your SE attends. 2 weeks.
Legal / Redlines	Procurement reviews MSA and order form. 2–4 weeks.

EB Sign-off

Economic Buyer final approval. Same week as legal.

PO Issuance

Finance issues purchase order. 3–5 business days.

Red Flags

- Prospect cannot describe their internal process — they may not be qualified buyers.
- The stated close date has no internal event anchoring it (budget deadline, go-live date).
- Legal review has not started in late-stage deals.
- You are unaware of a required step (e.g., security review) until it surfaces as a blocker.

Identify Pain

Surface the problem that demands urgent action

Pain is the critical business problem — felt by real people — that creates the urgency to act. Without identified and acknowledged pain, there is no compelling reason for the prospect to change, spend money, or move quickly. Great salespeople don't just uncover pain — they help prospects articulate it, quantify it, and feel the cost of inaction.

Levels of Pain

Level 1 — Latent	Prospect has a problem but hasn't fully recognised it. You must reveal it.
Level 2 — Active	Prospect knows the problem exists but hasn't prioritised solving it.
Level 3 — Vision	Prospect has a clear vision of the solution and is actively evaluating vendors.
Level 4 — Crisis	The problem is causing immediate, quantifiable damage. Urgency is high.

Pain vs. Problem vs. Implication

Use the **SPIN framework** to move from surface-level problems to deep implications:

- **Situation:** Understand the current state (neutral questions).
- **Problem:** Identify specific difficulties or dissatisfactions.
- **Implication:** Explore the downstream effects — what else does this cause?
- **Need-Payoff:** Help them articulate the value of solving it.

Discovery Questions

- What is the single biggest challenge you are trying to solve with this project?
- How long have you been dealing with this issue? What have you tried?
- What happens if this problem isn't solved in the next 6 months?
- Who is most impacted by this problem day-to-day?
- How is this affecting your ability to hit your goals this year?
- Is this a top-3 priority for your leadership team? What makes it urgent now?

Key Insight

Pain must be felt by the Economic Buyer, not just the end user. A technical team may suffer daily from a broken process, but if the EB doesn't connect that pain to a business outcome they care about, you won't get budget. Always translate user pain into executive impact.

Red Flags

- Pain is only expressed by end users, not sponsors or the EB.
- The prospect says 'it would be nice to have' — not a pain-driven purchase.
- No clear event is forcing a decision (contract expiry, go-live date, compliance deadline).
- Pain is acknowledged but the status quo feels 'good enough' to leadership.

C

Champion

Develop your internal seller and deal protector

A Champion is an individual inside the prospect organisation who believes in your solution, has personal stake in its success, and is willing to actively sell on your behalf when you are not in the room. A true champion is your single greatest asset in any deal — and the absence of one is the most common reason enterprise deals stall or are lost.

Champion vs. Coach vs. Sponsor

Role	Definition	What They Do For You
Coach	Anyone who shares intel	Gives you information — low commitment
Sponsor	An exec who likes you	Opens doors — but may not fight for you
Champion	Invested in your success	Sells internally, protects your deal, fights for budget

How to Identify a Champion

- They have **power** or influence with the Economic Buyer.
- They have a **personal win** tied to your solution's success.
- They provide you access to information, stakeholders, and meetings others can't.
- They push back on you honestly — false champions only tell you what you want to hear.
- They proactively work to move the deal forward without being prompted.

How to Develop a Champion

Invest in Their Success	Understand their personal goals and how this project helps them.
Share Your Intel	Give them information and insights that make them look smart internally.
Coach Them to Sell	Prepare them for internal presentations — give them slides, talk tracks.
Create a Joint Plan	Build a mutual success plan they co-own and can present upward.
Test Their Commitment	Ask them to do something: get you a meeting, share a document.

Maintain Frequency

Regular touchpoints keep you informed and the deal alive.

Champion Testing Questions

- Would you be willing to introduce me to [Economic Buyer] this week?
- Can you share the internal evaluation scorecard with me?
- What is the internal narrative around this project — how are people talking about it?
- If the deal stalled tomorrow, what would you do to unblock it?

Red Flags

- Your 'champion' cannot get you access to the EB or other stakeholders.
- They have no political capital with decision-makers.
- They stop returning calls when competition intensifies.
- They say 'I think we're the only vendor being evaluated' — overly optimistic.

MEDDIC Scoring & Deal Review

Use this scoring model during weekly pipeline reviews to identify gaps, prioritise actions, and create accurate forecasts. Score each element 0–2 and total the result.

Scoring Rubric

Element	0 — Not Identified	1 — Partially Known	2 — Fully Qualified
Metrics	No ROI/value defined	Some numbers discussed	Agreed ROI, validated by finance
Economic Buyer	EB unknown	Identified, not yet engaged	Engaged, aligned to value
Decision Criteria	No criteria known	Informal criteria shared	Formal criteria, shaped by us
Decision Process	No process known	High-level steps known	Full process mapped + timeline
Identify Pain	No pain surfaced	Pain known, not quantified	Pain quantified, felt by EB
Champion	No champion identified	Coach/sponsor only	True champion, tested

Score Interpretation

10–12 ✓ Commit	Strong qualification. High confidence to forecast. Focus on process and timeline.
7–9 ~ Upside	Solid deal with identifiable gaps. Prioritise closing the 1–2 missing elements.
4–6 ? Best Case	Meaningful gaps exist. Do not forecast without a recovery plan for weak areas.
0–3 ✗ Qualify Out	Poorly qualified. Reassign resources or re-enter at an earlier stage.

Deal Review Agenda Template

- **1 min** — Deal overview: company, size, close date, stage.
- **3 min** — MEDDIC score walk-through: rate each element, justify the score.
- **3 min** — Gap analysis: which element is lowest? Why?
- **2 min** — Next actions: one specific action per gap, owner, and deadline.
- **1 min** — Forecast category: Commit / Upside / Best Case / Qualify Out.

Discovery Questions Cheat Sheet

Use these questions across the MEDDIC elements in any discovery conversation. You don't need to ask all of them — pick the 2–3 most relevant for your stage.

M — Metrics

- What does success look like in measurable terms?
- What is the annual cost of this problem today?
- What ROI threshold do you need to justify this spend?
- How are you currently tracking performance in this area?

E — Economic Buyer

- Who owns the budget for this initiative?
- Has budget been allocated, or does it need approval?
- What are the Economic Buyer's top priorities this year?
- Can we arrange a meeting to validate the business case with them directly?

D — Decision Criteria

- What criteria matter most in your evaluation?
- Is there a formal RFP or scoring matrix?
- What would immediately disqualify a vendor?
- Who helped define the evaluation criteria?

D — Decision Process

- Walk me through your internal steps from here to signature.
- Who else needs to approve this before it moves forward?
- What does your legal/procurement review look like?
- What is driving your target decision date?

I — Identify Pain

- What is the single biggest challenge you're trying to solve?
- What happens if this isn't fixed in the next 6 months?
- Is this a top-3 priority for your executive team?
- How is this affecting your ability to hit your goals?

C — Champion

- Would you be willing to introduce me to [EB] this week?
- What's the internal narrative around this project?
- Can you share the evaluation scorecard?
- If the deal stalled, what would you do to unblock it?

Common Pitfalls & Best Practices

Even experienced reps make predictable MEDDIC mistakes. Use this section in coaching sessions and self-assessments to identify and fix the most common failure patterns.

The 7 Most Common MEDDIC Failures

#1 Single-threading	Relying on one contact. Build multi-threaded relationships across functions.
#2 Skipping the EB	Never meeting the Economic Buyer. No EB contact = no commit forecast.
#3 Wishful pain	Accepting vague pain without quantifying it. Always push for numbers.
#4 False champion	Mistaking a friendly contact for a true champion. Test commitment early.
#5 Unknown process	Not knowing the internal steps. Map every deal past Stage 2.
#6 Rep-owned ROI	The rep builds the business case alone. Co-create it with the champion.
#7 Late-stage surprises	Security review, legal, or board approval surfaces at the last minute.

Best Practices by Sales Stage

Stage	MEDDIC Focus	Key Action
Discovery (1–2)	Pain, Metrics	Quantify pain; start building ROI model
Evaluation (3)	DC, DP, Champion	Map criteria; identify and test champion
Proposal (4)	EB, Metrics	Gain EB access; validate business case
Negotiation (5)	DP, Champion	Map legal/procurement; prep champion to defend
Close (6)	All elements confirmed	No surprises — all six elements solid

Manager Coaching Reminders

- Never accept 'I think' or 'probably' in a deal review — require evidence for each element.
- If a rep can't name the Economic Buyer, the deal is not forecastable.

- Metrics should be in the prospect's words, not the rep's.
- A deal with a score below 6 should not be in Commit — move it to Best Case.
- Ask reps: 'When did you last speak with your champion?' If it's been two weeks, the deal is at risk.
- Use lost deal reviews to identify which MEDDIC elements were weakest and why.



MEDDIC is not a checklist — it is a mindset. The best sales professionals use it to think clearly about every deal, every day. When in doubt, go back to the basics: Do I know the pain? Do I have a champion? Do I have access to the EB? If any answer is no — that is your next action.

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